Bhindranwale in the Golden Temple complex. He could have stayed back or been held hostage by Bhindranwale.

Also, the presence of a US national in the Akal Takht at the time of Operation Blue Star would have created a number of problems. The US Embassy in India would have taken every possible measure to get him out alive before Blue Star began. But Dhillon, by that time, would have noticed or come to know quite a few things that the Indian government would not have wanted him to know. Also, though the chances of Dhillon convincing Bhindranwale to leave the Akal Takht were remote, Indira Gandhi possibly did not want to risk Bhindranwale walking out of the temple complex alive. It could not be the 'final solution' to the Punjab problem.

Given his charter, Kao could not have returned from London without meeting Jagjit Singh Chauhan, head of the 'National Council of Khalistan'. Besides, Kao must have met a number of prominent Sikh leaders from the UK and other countries. Regarding Kao's meetings with 'Khalistani elements', I don't think any one of them was in a position to convince Bhindranwale to vacate the Golden Temple complex, which Kao might have soon realized, if he did not know it before he left Delhi.

Obviously, those meetings did not produce any results. But Kao's secret and mysterious meetings with them in a quiet place like Zurich or even London might have created an impression on the Sikhs whom he met that the prime minister, who had specially sent Kao to talk to them, was actually serious about finding a peaceful solution to the Punjab problem. It was the same impression that the repeated negotiations with Akali leaders were creating in India.

On the basis of what has been written earlier in this book, the contents of Raman's and Alexander's books, and my own personal experience of dealing with Kao, the following things emerge about Kao's role during that period:

Kao knew about the overall requirements of Op-2 and did whatever was possible within his means to help it along. Regarding my own very limited role in furthering the cause of Op-2, I undertook my first visit to the US and Canada in December 1981 upon Kao's instructions conveyed through Suntook, and on return reported the outcome of my visit to him. It was again upon his